course of its history, the temperature of the universe has swept across an enormous range, from the ferociously hot moments just after the bang to the few degrees above absolute zero you'd find today if you took a thermometer into deep space. And, as I will explain in the next chapter, because of a critical interdependence between heat and symmetry, what we see today is likely but a cool remnant of the far richer symmetry that molded the early universe and determined some of the most familiar and essential features of the cosmos.